

volume and equaliser settings, you can do it once and for all by editing the song.

The most basic type of editing is Normalising. In plain terms, normalising audio is the act of amplifying it so that the loudest point on the waveform is just under the maximum output level. Basically, it's just amplifying the waveform as much as possible without clipping (see §5.7 for more on clipping).

If you use Windows Media Player 10, you can try and get all your music to have the same volume level by choosing the right setting when adding the music to your library.



Use Windows Media Player to import all songs with automatic volume levelling

As you can see in the screenshot, just check the “Add volume leveling values for all files (slow)” and then import all your music. Though this will take considerable amount of time for any collection over 1 GB, you can (and should) just leave it while it imports. Here’s one perfect example of how patience can pay off in the long run.

If you prefer some other media player, look for a similar volume levelling setting, which may also be called “Normalize.”

However, if you want a more permanent change, and wish to be able to play all your music in *any* media player on *any* computer or even a portable device, and do not want spikes and dips in the volume levels, you can edit the songs using an audio editing software such as the open source Audacity, or Adobe Audition.